

# FARINA SAHER

Leader | Economics Researcher | Climate & SDGs | Policy & Development

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

M.Phil Economics researcher and youth leader with experience in organizational leadership, community development, youth engagement, research, programme coordination, and digital communication. Currently serving as President of Alif Welfare Foundation – Faisalabad Chapter, with practical experience in leading teams, coordinating community initiatives, and managing organizational activities.

Strongly interested in climate action, Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), biodiversity, public policy, governance, women's economic empowerment, and inclusive development. Experienced in quantitative research, data analysis, academic writing, stakeholder engagement, and youth-focused initiatives. Committed to contributing to evidence-based solutions and meaningful youth participation in national development.

## EDUCATION

### M.Phil Economics

Lahore College for Women University (LCWU), Lahore

[10-11-2024] – Present

**Thesis:** Socio-Economic Barriers to Digital Literacy and Women's Economic Empowerment in District Mandi Bahauddin, Punjab, Pakistan

### Bachelor of Science (Economics)

Lahore College for Women University, Lahore

2020 – 2024

## PROFESSIONAL / LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

### 2026 – Present

- Lead the organizational activities and team coordination of Alif Welfare Foundation.
- Support the recruitment and selection of volunteers for different organizational departments.

- Coordinate with applicants and volunteers throughout recruitment and onboarding processes.
- Organize team structures and assign responsibilities according to members' skills and interests.
- Lead HR-related coordination, including volunteer communication, team formation, and follow-up.
- Coordinate with department leads and volunteers to ensure effective completion of assigned responsibilities.
- Conduct and support orientation and onboarding activities for new volunteers.
- Maintain professional communication with team members and applicants through digital communication channels.
- Support documentation and organizational record-keeping related to volunteers and activities.
- Contribute to fundraising, social media, documentation, finance, and community-development activities through cross-functional coordination.

## **HR & Finance Management — Alif Welfare Foundation**

### **2026 – Present**

- Support HR planning, volunteer coordination, and internal team management.
- Assist in organizing recruitment processes and assigning volunteers to relevant departments.
- Coordinate with team members regarding tasks, deadlines, meetings, and organizational activities.
- Support financial coordination, budgeting-related activities, and basic record management.
- Work collaboratively with different departments to ensure smooth organizational operations.

## **MEMBERSHIP, YOUTH & ORGANIZATIONAL EXPERIENCE**

### **General Member — Pakistan Youth Research & Institute (PJ&RI)**

#### **2026 – Present**

- Participate in organizational and research-related activities.
- Engage with members and youth-led initiatives.
- Contribute to collaborative organizational activities and professional development opportunities.
- Develop experience in communication, teamwork, research, and organizational coordination.

### **Committee In-Charge — NYLP Media Team**

#### **2026 – Present**

- Coordinate media-related team activities and assigned tasks.
- Communicate with team members and coordinate deliverables.
- Support planning and execution of organizational campaigns and events.
- Assist in managing digital content, promotional materials, and team coordination.

#### **NYLP & IMUN Ambassador**

##### **2026 – Present**

- Represent organizational initiatives and communicate opportunities to youth.
- Support outreach, engagement, and participation activities.
- Develop professional communication and networking skills through youth engagement.

#### **GFB Campus Ambassador**

##### **2026 – Present**

- Support campus-level outreach and awareness activities.
- Engage with students and promote organizational initiatives.
- Coordinate communication and participation among students.

### **VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE**

#### **Volunteer — SHE Leadership Initiative**

##### **2026 – Present**

- Participate in leadership and youth-development initiatives.
- Collaborate with team members on organizational activities and projects.

#### **Volunteer — GFB**

##### **2026 – Present**

- Support organizational activities, campaigns, and volunteer initiatives.
- Contribute to teamwork, communication, and community-oriented activities.

#### **Core Team Member — Chort Zero**

- Collaborated with team members on organizational and youth-focused initiatives.
- Supported planning, coordination, and implementation of assigned activities.

#### **Volunteer — Volunteer Leading Governance (VLG)**

- Participated in volunteer-based initiatives focused on youth engagement and organizational development.

## CLIMATE, SDGs & DEVELOPMENT EXPERIENCE

### Global Biodiversity Diplomacy & Policy Training

#### Global Biodiversity Framework (GFB)

- Developed knowledge of biodiversity diplomacy and environmental policy.
- Explored the role of youth in biodiversity conservation and sustainable development.
- Gained exposure to global environmental governance and sustainability frameworks.

#### Areas of Climate & Development Interest

- Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)
- Climate Action
- Biodiversity Conservation
- Environmental Sustainability
- Youth Climate Leadership
- Sustainable Development
- Inclusive Economic Development
- Women's Economic Empowerment
- Digital Inclusion
- Community Development
- Evidence-Based Policy

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

### M.Phil Economics Researcher

#### Lahore College for Women University

#### Research Area: Digital Literacy & Women's Economic Empowerment

- Conduct quantitative research using primary survey data.
- Develop and analyze research models related to socio-economic barriers and women's economic empowerment.
- Apply statistical and econometric techniques for empirical research.
- Use SmartPLS for PLS-SEM and mediation analysis.
- Conduct literature reviews and systematic literature reviews using PRISMA 2020.
- Interpret quantitative findings and develop evidence-based research conclusions.
- Work with research tools and statistical software including SPSS, Stata, EViews, R, Python, and SmartPLS.

#### Research & Publication

## **Gender Equality in Employment in Pakistan – PJRI**

- Contributed to research and publication work examining gender equality and employment-related issues in Pakistan.

### **PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE**

#### **Intern – Audit & Assurance**

##### **Ahmad Mushir & Salariya Chartered Accountants (AM&SCA)**

- Completed a six-week professional internship in Audit & Assurance.
- Gained exposure to professional documentation, auditing procedures, and organizational practices.
- Developed professional communication, analytical, and teamwork skills.

#### **Intern – Division of Legal Training & Development**

##### **Pakistan Journal of Research & Innovation (PJRI)**

- Participated in legal, human rights, and development-oriented learning activities.
- Supported research and awareness initiatives

### **LEADERSHIP & MANAGEMENT SKILLS**

- Team Leadership
- Strategic Planning
- Volunteer Coordination
- Programme Coordination
- Event Management
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Community Mobilization
- Youth Engagement
- Project Coordination
- Communication & Public Relations
- Team Building
- Campaign Coordination
- Problem Solving
- Research & Policy Analysis

### **RESEARCH & TECHNICAL SKILLS**

**Data & Research:** SPSS | SmartPLS | Stata | EViews | RStudio | Python | Biblioshiny  
**Productivity:** Microsoft Excel | Word | PowerPoint | Google Workspace  
**Design & Digital:** Canva | Social Media Management | Digital Marketing | Content Creation  
**Other:** Data Analysis | Data Reporting | Research Writing | Documentation

## CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- Global Biodiversity Diplomacy & Policy Training – GFB
- Data Science & AI for Social Science
- Statistical Analysis of Data for Researchers
- Research Paper Writing
- GenAI Prompt Engineering Basics – Coursera
- IBM Generative AI Essentials
- GenAI Application Developer
- Digital Marketing & E-commerce
- Fundamental Rights under the Constitution of Pakistan
- Human Rights Awareness / Legal & Human Rights Awareness – PJRI
- NYLP-IMUN Leadership & Programme Training
- International Leadership Summit on Youth Development

## LEADERSHIP & DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITIES

- NYLP Cohort Zero – Core Team Member
- NYLP Intern
- IMUN Ambassador
- NYLP Campus Ambassador
- GFB Campus Ambassador
- SHE Leadership Volunteer
- VLG Member / Volunteer
- PJRI General Member
- Alif Welfare Foundation – President, Faisalabad Chapter and Social Media Director

## AREAS OF INTEREST

### **Leadership & Governance:**

Youth Leadership, Governance, Civic Engagement, Public Policy, Parliamentary Engagement

### **Climate & Sustainable Development:**

Climate Action, SDGs, Biodiversity, Environmental Sustainability, Sustainable Development

### **Economics & Research:**

Development Economics, Women's Economic Empowerment, Digital Literacy, Financial Inclusion, Data Analysis, Evidence-Based Policy

### **Social Development:**

Youth Development, Women & Girls, Human Rights, Community Development, Inclusive Growth

## LANGUAGE

- English
- Urdu
- Punjabi